



Rename

It is not easy to succeed the first time of asking. But true victory belongs to those who do not give up in the face of failure. Bearers of success have always known to dust-off and get back on track after things don't work out some place. Here, we trace that spirit across a plethora of success stories that transformed the world, but not before they transformed themselves.

“There’s a lot in a name”

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When you think about it, renaming is a simple enough thing to do, and even easier to comprehend. But calling something a completely new name from what it was before, affects human psychology exactly the way something entirely new would do in the condition. Citation: the world around us.

It is said that the human body constantly regenerates itself, in that you have a completely new one every seven years. So the question is, are you the same person, every time this happens? Well, of course you are – we’ve not met anybody who claims to be a different person every seven years. But that is because maybe physically changing something is not quite enough – you have to go the whole nine yards. Changing name, altering your personality, changing your face, things like that. But most importantly, changing your name. As much

as we want to side with Shakespeare in thinking “what’s in a name”, we have with an alarming regularity, seen the answer to that – “quite a bit”, it would seem.

Apparently, people are more willing to give a second (or, you know, third and beyond) shot to any name that they have not yet associated with an idea. This is why most startups change their names and start working on something significantly different from their original vision, and much like the effects of the legendary paint jobs in Grand Theft Auto, the people give a look, and they go “meh”. But we were intrigued with the idea of the flag-bearers in this practice, and sure enough, we came across winners, and a lot of them.

Pinterest

Let us start with one of the hottest supposed success stories in recent time – Pinterest. How does the idea of carrying a mini clothing retail outlet in your pocket sound? We think it could work, but

doesn’t make us sit up and take notice. But the fact of the matter remains, that Pinterest started out as Tote – a company that did exactly that. But it was not particularly good at what it did – selling things. Allegedly, the payment system was a mess, and thus the whole buying idea was difficult to push through. Which for an e-commerce setup was, well a bad day

in the office – everyday until its existence. But there was something that the app managed to do pretty well – storing and sharing the buyers’ wishlists. And this was where Ben Silbermann saw the light – that people only just want to have a favourite bunch of things, and share it with one another. ‘People’ here meaning mostly teenaged girls, but hey, whatever